

- Dates – Agree on a sensible format for dates, e.g. YYYY-MM-DD.
- Order - specify which element should come first to ensure that files with the same theme are presented together and therefore readily identified.
- Numbers – provide the number of digits to be used in the file numbering, e.g. 01, 002, etc.



Pick a known file naming standard

Revisioning files

Rarely are documents written in a single session by a single person. Typically, multiple persons will be involved in the process, which will last an extended period of time. Without adequate safeguards, this might easily result in uncertainty over the most recent version. Here is one approach to avoid this:

- Utilize a revision' approach for numbering. Any significant modifications to a file can be denoted by whole numbers; for instance, v01 would be the first version, while v02 would be the second. Minor changes can be signalled by increasing the decimal figure; for example, v01 01 indicates that the first version has been modified, whereas v03 01 indicates that the third version has been modified.
- When draught papers are sent out for revisions, they should be returned with additional information identifying the individual who made the revisions. For instance, a file named datav01 20130816 SJ indicates that a coworker (SJ) amended the first version on August 16, 2013. The lead author would then include those changes into version v01 and rename the file to adhere to the revision numbering system.
- Include a 'version control table' for each critical document, documenting